

Over the past two decades or so, computers and the internet have become an integral part of our everyday lives. People of all ages depend on digital technology, right from kids for games to teenagers who use it for educational and recreational activities like chatting, and adults who use it to make life much simpler and more productive. Almost every aspect of life has become digital, be it bank transactions or product purchase. It's high on accessibility, interactability and convenience. What's not to like? Unfortunately, this also makes it a hotspot for criminal activity. Because of the ease of access, and the potential damage that could be caused, cybercriminals are, in the modern world, perhaps the most dangerous type of criminals in existence. No wonder cyber crime has risen to the top priority for most governments to tackle, seeing how it's a constant threat to individuals, businesses and politics.

Defining Cyber Crime

So how exactly do we define “cyber crime”? Fundamentally any illegal activity committed using a computer and/or the internet can be called a cyber crime. Although the term is usually reserved for criminal activity wherein a computer or the internet is the location of the crime, it's also used to include traditional crimes in which computers or the internet are chief tools used in enabling the illegal activity. New technology in general creates new avenues for crime,

but not necessarily new types of crime. Criminals could commit fraud, thievery, identity theft, etc. even without the help of tech. These atrocities existed long before the word “cyber” came along. Thus, cyber



crime is basically an extension of existing criminal activity, perhaps making it easier while also adding new dimensions to its execution. Broadly put, cyber crime could be defined as “an illegal act where a computer or a computer network serves as the location, means, target or source of the act”. Legally also, this definition of cyber crime was agreed upon by most of the